PARADOX LOG

Detailed Six-Act Story, Choices & Flow

A more detailed narrative blueprint describing what each Act is about, what happens inside it, the player's major decisions, the information revealed, and how each Act moves the story toward the final judgment.

Important Design Note

This document distinguishes established story decisions from details that still need to be designed. Where the existing project material does not define an exact choice set, the choice is marked TBD rather than being presented as established canon.

ACT I — THE CONSEQUENCE

Playable Character: Future Self

Purpose: Introduce the broken timeline, establish the mystery, and make the player experience consequences before understanding their causes.

Opening

Future Self wakes inside an abandoned research facility. Systems are damaged, records are corrupted, and evidence suggests that Future Self has been here before despite not remembering it. The opening question becomes: Why does Future Self already seem connected to the disaster?

The Terminal

The player discovers an old terminal containing information about the facility and the timeline. Established choices are: Access the terminal, Destroy the terminal, or Ignore it. These choices create different knowledge and flag states rather than simply giving obvious morality points.

The Abandoned Station

Future Self reaches an abandoned station or settlement and meets a stranger who appears to know something about them. The exact relationship choices are TBD, but the scene establishes an early trust decision that can affect later interactions.

The Time Anchor

Future Self discovers the Time Anchor and learns that stabilizing the timeline may require sacrificing something else. The central idea is introduced: fixing the timeline does not necessarily mean restoring everything.

Major Priority

The player must prioritize one of three established outcomes: Save the City, Save the Research Facility, or Save the Trapped People. These become persistent consequences that can reappear later.

Act Ending

Future Self receives the message 'STOP TRYING TO FIX ME.' The player now suspects that Future Self is not merely fighting the timeline problem but may be part of it.

ACT II — THE FIRST INTERFERENCE

Playable Character: Past Self

Purpose: Move the player into the past and reveal that the future is already interfering with the present.

Opening

The player becomes Past Self in a relatively normal city. The destroyed future of Act I has not happened yet. This creates dramatic irony because the player already knows that something is wrong.

Chrono Blade

Past Self discovers the Chrono Blade, which can reveal possible future consequences during dialogue. The tool introduces the idea that future outcomes can influence present decisions, while leaving room for uncertainty about whether those visions are reliable.

Temporal Scientist

Past Self encounters a scientist researching temporal anomalies. The player learns that strange events, repeating patterns, contradictory memories, and temporal disturbances are already appearing.

The Warning

Past Self receives the message 'DON'T SAVE HER.' The identity of 'her' becomes the focus of the next sequence.

The Scientist's Daughter

Past Self encounters the scientist's daughter. The player must decide whether to follow the warning, ignore it, or investigate its meaning. The exact final option set is TBD.

Act Ending

Past Self receives another warning: 'DON'T TRUST YOUR FUTURE SELF.' The player realizes that Future Self has been influencing Past Self's decisions.

ACT III — THE CORRECTION

Playable Character: Future Self

Purpose: Show that previous choices genuinely changed reality and reveal that there is more than one timeline.

Changed Future

Future Self wakes in a future that is different from Act I. People, locations, and outcomes may have changed because of earlier decisions.

Contradictory Memories

Future Self experiences memories that disagree with each other. The player can remember an event one way while the current timeline says it happened differently. The reliability of memory becomes part of the mystery.

Timeline Rewrite

Future Self gains access to a mechanism capable of rewriting part of the timeline. The player may preserve the current timeline, correct a previous mistake, or rewrite a major event. The exact choice set is TBD.

Another Self

Future Self discovers evidence of another version of themselves. This establishes that attempts to repair reality may have created additional timelines rather than simply restoring one original timeline.

Act Ending

The central question changes from 'How do I fix the timeline?' to 'Which timeline deserves to exist?'

ACT IV — THE ORIGIN

Playable Character: Past Self

Purpose: Reveal why Future Self became authoritarian and show that the antagonist was originally trying to save everyone.

Hidden Facility

Past Self enters a hidden temporal research facility containing records that were deliberately kept away from the public.

Future Self's Recording

Past Self discovers an earlier recording of Future Self. This version is not yet authoritarian and genuinely wants to save everyone.

Failed Timelines

The records reveal repeated attempts to prevent the catastrophe. Each attempt produces another failure or unintended consequence. The player begins to understand why Future Self eventually became convinced that normal choice was not enough.

Singularity Core

Past Self discovers the Singularity Core, a powerful temporal mechanism capable of bringing timelines toward convergence. Its power makes the final conflict possible.

Philosophical Break

Future Self eventually concludes that free will itself is the unpredictable variable. If people can make different choices, different timelines can emerge. Therefore, Future Self begins believing that controlling choice is the only way to guarantee stability.

Act Ending

The player now understands Future Self without necessarily agreeing with them. The conflict becomes Freedom vs Control rather than simply Hero vs Villain.

ACT V — THE NECESSARY MONSTER

Playable Character: Future Self

Purpose: Make the player seriously question whether Future Self's authoritarian approach might actually be justified.

Oppressive Future

Future Self exists in a highly controlled society. The timeline is comparatively stable, but personal freedom has been reduced. Temporal anomalies are controlled and dangerous choices are restricted.

Resistance

A resistance movement opposes Future Self. They believe control has gone too far and want to restore freedom. Future Self believes the resistance will recreate the catastrophe.

Major Event

A major temporal event begins. Future Self must decide how aggressively to intervene. The exact options are TBD, but the decision should affect Tyrant Index and Timeline Stability.

Past Self Appears

Past Self unexpectedly appears in Future Self's timeline. The two versions finally confront each other directly.

Truth

Both selves reveal that they were trying to prevent the same catastrophe but reached opposite conclusions. Past Self believes people must remain free to choose. Future Self believes uncontrolled choice is why every timeline fails.

Singularity Reactivates

The Singularity Core activates again. This time Future Self can no longer make the final decision. Only Past Self can determine what happens next.

ACT VI — THE FINAL JUDGMENT

Playable Character: Past Self

Purpose: Resolve the philosophical conflict and evaluate the player's accumulated choices to determine the ending.

Entering the Singularity

Past Self enters the Singularity and encounters fragments of previous decisions. Earlier choices, saved people, failed outcomes, timeline changes, and Future Self's actions become relevant to the final judgment.

Final Confrontation

Past Self confronts Future Self directly. Future Self argues that control is necessary; Past Self must decide whether stability is worth sacrificing freedom.

State Evaluation

The game evaluates Tyrant Index, Timeline Stability, Self-Trust, and important hidden flags. These values determine which final outcome is possible.

Final Outcomes

The established conceptual endings are: The Tyrant, The Sacrifice, The Reset, The Fracture, and The Reconciliation. Exact thresholds and hidden-flag requirements remain TBD.

New Game+

The Reset ending can lead into New Game+, where the player remembers the previous timeline and can approach the story with knowledge from the completed run.

OVERALL ACT PROGRESSION

Act	Playable	Main Question	Major Reveal
I	Future Self	What happened?	Future Self may be part of the problem.
II	Past Self	Can I prevent it?	Future Self is influencing events.
III	Future Self	Which timeline is real?	Multiple timelines exist.
IV	Past Self	Why did Future Self become this way?	Future Self originally wanted to save everyone.
V	Future Self	Is control necessary?	Both selves want the same outcome.
VI	Past Self	What should happen to the timeline?	The player makes the final judgment.

Core progression: Mystery → Investigation → Timeline Confusion → Origin/Understanding → Confrontation → Final Judgment.

Design principle: each Act should introduce new information and consequences instead of repeating the same exposition. Exact choice wording, thresholds, and some scene-level branches remain to be finalized in the choice matrix and content files.